

Computer on the move

It's as small as most conventional PDAs, but is actually marketed as a Palmtop. As a Palmtop Computer, it's fantastic. It integrates a keyboard that is recessed into the device—as the case opens, the keyboard slides out from underneath, making it effectively larger than it is when closed.

PSion 5mx



SPECIFICATIONS:

Integrated keyboard, serial cable, built-in microphone, PsiWin software, Compact Flash slot, no support for PC and Ethernet cards, runs on two AA batteries

verdict

B

PSion 5mx

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Excellent voice recording capability
- Very expensive
- No support for LAN cards
Price: Rs 32,000
Contact: Ingram Micro
Phone: 6833726, 6834688
Web site: www.imindia.com

Affordable 5.1 system

An affordable alternative to the expensive 5.1 systems, it didn't compromise in quality in any of the tests. It has wall-mounting hinges that can be attached to the satellites, so you can mount the speakers comfortably. The speakers generated good high frequencies, but at low frequencies the bass sounded weak.

Mercury SR-301F



SPECIFICATIONS:

2000-watt PMPO 5.1 surround sound speaker system, supports 4.1 channel and enhanced two-channel stereo, 2.5-inch 3-watt RMS satellites, 2.75-inch 5-watt RMS centre speaker, powerful 4-inch 22-watt RMS subwoofer, wireless remote, no Dolby Digital decoder

verdict

B

Mercury SR-301F

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Wireless remote plus console
+ Good low-frequency response
- Overall power not too impressive
Price: Rs 4,600
Contact: Neoteric Infomatique
Phone: 022-4172600; **Fax:** 022-4163679
E-mail: sales@neoteric-info.com
Web site: www.neoteric-info.com

Portable storage capacity

A portable storage product for users who need larger capacity on the move. The drive tested by us had a capacity of 10 GB but 20 GB variants are also available. It does not require any other third-party application for running and backing up data. It has an LCD interface that displays the data transfer speed.

Iomega Peerless 10 GB Drive



SPECIFICATIONS:

System requirements: USB Port in IBM, IBM-compatible and Macintosh computers; Win98/98SE/Me/2000, Mac8.6 and higher OS
Features: One USB interface cable, one power cable, three CDs including drivers, **Bundled software:** Iomega Quick Sync, MGI PhotoSuite and MGI Videowave
Benchmarks: Random access time of 19.7 ms in HDtch, 837 Kbps random read and 911 Kbps write in SiSoft Sandra, Drive Index score of 914

verdict

B +

Iomega Peerless 10 GB Drive

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
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Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Huge storage capacity
+ Bundled applications
- Needs power for ejecting media
Price: Rs 26,990
Contact: Iomega Pacific Pvt Ltd, India
Phone: 9820267791
Fax: 022-6527023
E-mail: menon@iomega.com

Good performer

This hard drive from Samsung has a capacity of 60 GB with a 5400-rpm spindle speed. The drive was not at all noisy and caused no heating problems while running the tests. However, the drive was shipped only with an anti-static cover, making it prone to physical damage due to possible mishandling during transportation.

Samsung SV 6004 H



SPECIFICATIONS:

60 GB capacity, 5400 rpm spindle speed, ATA/100, 20 GB per platter, IDE interface
Benchmarks: 29 MBps sequential read and 7 MBps random read in SiSoft Sandra 2001, 28 MBps in sequential write and 6 MBps in random write tests, average access time of 7 ms, burst speed of above 80 MBps and random access time of 9.7 ms in HDtch test

verdict

B +

Samsung SV 6004 H

Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Build Quality	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ No heating problems
- No proper packaging
Price: Rs 8,000
Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information and Telecommunication Ltd
Phone: 011-6322517; **Fax:** 011-6322607
E-mail: marketing@samsungindia.com
Web site: www.samsungindia.com